ASML

3Q26 First Take: Key points include the very strong gross margin and '26 guidance outgrowing WFE.

Overweight

ANALYST FOCUS LIST

ASML.AS, ASML NA
Price (13 Oct 26):€1,521.20
Price Target (Jun-28):€2,100.00

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Our Take: ASML's reported 3Q results were ahead of market expectations, driven by better-than-guided gross margin of 57.5%. The company has also guided sales/ gross margin and EBIT in 4Q which is ahead of consensus. The full year EBIT guidance is ~5.5% ahead of consensus estimates. Unlike in past years, a key point in the guidance increase is that the company's growth of 36.2% at the midpoint is ahead of JPMe 2026 WFE growth of 31%, indicating that ASML is outgrowing WFE and the historical bear case of litho intensity declining has been debunked (despite it being the first year of the upturn when ASML takes longer to start up the production due to its longer lead times). ASML has not provided any guidance into 2027. The forward indications provided are that the company has now received orders over the past quarter that its current capacity in 2027 and 2028 does not allow it to fully meet. The company is now looking at ways to expand capacity in 2028 beyond the 30% growth previously guided (after 30% already seen in 2027). The lack of a more specific 2027 guidance or that of capacity plans in 2028 could slightly disappoint investors. We believe that the better than WFE 2026 growth and that it will expand capacity beyond what was previously planned in 2028 are very positive indications.

- **Noteworthy Areas:** ASML reported 3Q sales of €11.7bn, which is 0.2%/-0.4% above JPMe/Bloomberg consensus and above company guidance of €11.5bn at the mid-point of the guided range. 3Q sales broke down into €8.4bn of net system sales and €3.3bn of Installed Base Management (IBM) sales. Revenue beat was driven by ~€370m higher IBM sales than expected. 3Q gross margin of 57.5% came in at above company guidance (of 55-57%) and 132bps/134bps above JPMe/consensus, driven by higher installed base management revenue and the greater revenue scale. The company beat on operating income, reporting €5.2bn (44.4% margin) for 3Q, which was 4.9%/5.3% above JPMe/consensus. 3Q diluted EPS of €12.93/share stood 19.2%/20.8% above JPMe/consensus. Though ASML no longer reports orders, the co. indicates strong order book momentum in the quarter that continues to increase quarter on quarter. The demand is so considerable that customers also want to place orders for 2029 and 2030. The company indicates that based on its order book momentum, it will not be able to fully fulfill the orders in 2027 and 2028 and is thus investigating plans to expand capacity beyond the 30% previously indicated in 2028.

- **Outlook & Guidance:** ASML expects 4Q26 sales between €14.2bn and €15.2bn, or €14.7bn at the midpoint. The midpoint of ASML's 4Q26 sales guidance is 5.2% above consensus. The company expects 4Q26 gross margin to be around 57%, i.e. 60bps above the consensus estimate of 56.4%. ASML's implied 4Q26 operating income of €6,779m (46.1% operating margin) is 9.2% above consensus. For FY26, ASML raised its revenue guidance from €43-€45bn to €44-€45bn, €44.5bn at the midpoint, which implies a 36.2% YoY growth and FY26 gross margin is expected to be around 56%. ASML is investigating plans to expand capacity in 2028 beyond the 30% growth (after 30% in 2027) that they had previously guided.

- **Likely changes to consensus:** Based on the guidance, we expect 4Q26

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consensus operating income expectations to increase by almost 10%. For FY26, with new revenue and gross margin guidance both above consensus estimates, we expect consensus earnings estimates to rise by higher than mid single digit %.

- **Peer read-across:** ASML's positive order indication where clients even want to place orders into '29 and '30 are positive indications for all semi cap stocks.
- **Valuation:** ASML trades on a '26E/'27E/'28E P/E of 39.3x/28.3x/21.6x, EV/Revenue of 13.3x/10.3x/8.4x and EV/EBITDA of 30.9x/22.7x/17.8x (as of October 13th, 2026).
- **Conference Call Details:** Management are to host a conference call today at 2pm UK time/3pm CET. Click here to join the call.

Actual vs Expected:

Table 1: ASML 3Q26 - Actual vs JPMe/Cons

€m	3Q26 Actual	3Q26 JPMe	3Q26 Cons	% vs. JPMe	% vs. Cons.
Equipment revenue	8,373.2	8,738.5	8,787.8	-4.2%	-4.7%
Service revenue	3,288.8	2,900.0	2,918.8	13.4%	12.7%
Revenue	**11,662.0**	**11,638.5**	**11,703.9**	**0.2%**	**-0.4%**
Gross Profit	**6,699.8**	**6,532.7**	**6,567.3**	**2.6%**	**2.0%**
Gross Margin	57.4%	56.1%	56.1%	132bps	134bps
Operating Income, reported	**5,172.8**	**4,932.7**	**4,911.6**	**4.9%**	**5.3%**
Margin	44.4%	42.4%	42.0%	197bps	239bps
Net income, reported	4,960.4	4,166.6	4,110.5	19.1%	20.7%
Margin	42.5%	35.8%	35.1%	673bps	741bps
EPS, clean diluted	**12.93**	**10.84**	**10.71**	**19.2%**	**20.8%**

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates, Bloomberg Finance L.P. consensus.

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Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

ASML *(Overweight; Price Target: €2,100.00)*

Investment Thesis
ASML is the sole supplier of EUV tools and its market share in the lithography segment should exceed 80-89% (seen in the last decade) driven by higher EUV ASP. The shift to High-NA that should start in '27 should help litho intensity improve as should greater EUV adoption in DRAM. The industry environment has changed significantly in recent quarters with a significant increase in DRAM prices. ASML, with its exposure to all the major memory companies, should be a significant beneficiary of a memory up-cycle.

Valuation
Our ASML target price is €2,100 ($2,400) which is equivalent to 29.6x our '28 EPS. ASML has historically traded at 28-38x forward earnings in the last five years (interquartile range) and at an average multiple of 33x. Our multiple is thus at the lower end of ASML's trading range indicating that the target price is earnings and not multiple driven, and to reflect that we are factoring in that this is an up-cycle price target.

Risks to Rating and Price Target
We believe the key risks that could prevent the stock from achieving our price target are: 1) export restrictions on tools to key geographies, such as China; and 2) an economic downturn, which would jeopardise our earnings estimates and PT. Further, lower-than-expected EUV adoption could imply downside to our estimates. Continuing increase in interest rates would also be negative to the multiple used and, thus, negative to our target price.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 13 October 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
ASML ADR(ASML/$1,717.76/OW)

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ASML (ASML.AS, ASML NA) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (€)	Price Target (€)
30-Nov-23	OW	629.20	800
30-Jan-24	OW	804.80	950
05-Apr-24	OW	901.30	1,100
16-Oct-24	OW	668.10	1,057
17-Apr-25	OW	574.00	970
17-Jul-25	OW	625.80	822
06-Oct-25	OW	880.10	1,000
01-Dec-25	OW	904.70	1,100
14-Jan-26	OW	1102.60	1,300
29-Jan-26	OW	1194.40	1,515
03-Jun-26	OW	1461.80	1,900
16-Jul-26	OW	1549.40	2,100

ASML ADR (ASML, ASML US) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Sep 19, 2012. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price ($)	Price Target ($)
19-Oct-23	OW	583.25	726
30-Nov-23	OW	687.61	878
25-Jan-24	OW	847.31	872
30-Jan-24	OW	882.62	1,026
05-Apr-24	OW	953.41	1,196
18-Apr-24	OW	907.61	1,172
18-Jul-24	OW	932.06	1,202
09-Oct-24	OW	824.26	1,207
16-Oct-24	OW	730.43	1,148
30-Jan-25	OW	712.65	1,100
17-Apr-25	OW	634.93	1,104
17-Jul-25	OW	754.45	957
06-Oct-25	OW	1032.22	1,175
01-Dec-25	OW	1060.00	1,275
14-Jan-26	OW	1270.16	1,518
29-Jan-26	OW	1422.92	1,813
03-Jun-26	OW	1705.37	2,200
16-Jul-26	OW	1815.27	2,400

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